

About Authority Integrity Standard (AIS)

Governing Identity Authority

Authority Integrity Standard (AIS) defines the governance conditions under which authority over a governed identity remains legitimate, attributable, verifiable, delegated, and continuously governable throughout the complete identity lifecycle.

A governed identity may have an owner.

It may also have one or more authorized authorities acting on its behalf.

AIS governs this identity governance space.

What Is Identity Authority?

Identity authority is the governed relationship that determines who may legitimately control, administer, represent, manage, or exercise governance rights over a governed identity while preserving governance integrity, accountability, and trust.

It enables organizations to establish legitimate authority, delegate governance rights, validate authority relationships, preserve authority boundaries, and ensure that every governance action remains authorized throughout the complete identity lifecycle.

Canonical Definition

Authority Integrity Standard (AIS) defines the structural conditions under which authority over a governed identity remains legitimate, attributable, verifiable, delegated, and continuously governable throughout the complete identity lifecycle.

Why AIS Exists

Ownership alone does not determine who may legitimately act.

Organizations delegate authority.

Individuals authorize representatives.

Digital identities may be governed by designated administrators.

Without governed authority, governance actions become ambiguous, permissions lose legitimacy, accountability weakens, and trust deteriorates.

AIS exists because Identity Authority represents the **fourth governable space** of **OBIDENTITY® — Origin-Bound Identity Governance Architecture**.

What AIS Governs

AIS governs the structural conditions under which identity authority remains:

- legitimate,
- attributable,
- verifiable,
- delegated,
- bounded,
- governable.

Rather than governing organizational hierarchies or legal authorization frameworks, AIS governs the governance conditions required for trustworthy identity authority.

Architectural Position

Authority Integrity Standard serves as the **fourth governance space** of **OBIDENTITY® — Origin-Bound Identity Governance Architecture**.

It establishes the governance foundation that determines who may legitimately exercise governance over a governed identity before permissions are granted, responsibilities are assigned, provenance is established, transfers occur, continuity is preserved, and auditability is achieved.

Without governed authority, trustworthy identity governance cannot be sustained.

Canonical Closing Statement

Ownership answers who possesses a governed identity. Authority answers who may legitimately govern it. Authority Integrity preserves this distinction by ensuring that every exercise of authority remains legitimate throughout the complete identity lifecycle.

Related Documents

[→ Authority Integrity Standard \(AIS\)](#)

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Canonical Source

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